Cory's Ancient Fragments (ed. E. Richmond Hodges, 1876) — Berossus and Abydenus on the Flood (Xisuthrus / Sisithrus) — OCR extract

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A. Abydenus, Of the Chaldaean kings and the Deluge (OCR lines 3015–3080; Cory cites Syncellus 38, Eusebius Praep. Evang. ix, Chron. 5, 8)

It is said that the first king of the country was Alorus1, who gave out a report that he was appointed by God to be the Shepherd of the people : he reigned ten sari. Now a sarus is esteemed to be three thousand six hundred years ; a neros, six hundred : and a sossus, sixty.

After him Alaparus reigned three sari ; to him succeeded Amillarus, from the city of Pantibiblon, who reigned thirteen sari ; in his time a semi-daemon called Annedotus, very like to Oannes,2 came up a second time from the sea. After him Ammenon reigned twelve sari, who was of the city of Pantibiblon3 ; then Megalarus, of the same place, eighteen sari ; then Daos, the shepherd, governed for the space of ten sari, he was of Pantibiblon ; in his time four double-shaped personages came out of the sea to land, whose names were Euedocus, Eneugamus,

1 Ur, an ancient Babylonian deity, mentioned in the Cuneiform inscription of Urukh as the eldest son of Bel. — See Records of the Past, vol. iii. pp. 9, 10.

2 Perhaps the god Anu, of the Assyrian inscriptions.

3 Sippara, or Sepharvaim.

*i

Eneuboulos, and Anementus. After these things
was Anodaphus, in the time of Euedoreschus.
There were afterwards other kings, and last of all
Sisithrus (Xisuthrus). So that, in all, the number
amounted to ten kings, and the term of their reigns
to one hundred and twenty sari. And, among
other matters not irrelevant to the subject, he con-
tinues thus concerning the deluge. After Euedo-
reschus some others reigned, and then Sisithrus
(Xisuthrus). To him the god Kronus (i.e. Saturn)
foretold that, on the fifteenth day of the month Desius
there would be a Deluge, and commanded him to
deposit all the writings whatever he had in the city
of the Sun, in Sippara. Sisithrus (Xisuthrus), when
he had complied with these commands, instantly
sailed to Armenia, and was immediately inspired
by God. During the prevalence of the waters
Sisithrus (Xisuthrus) sent out birds that he might
judge if the flood had subsided. But the birds pas-
sing over an unbounded sea, and not finding any
place of rest returned again to Sisithrus. This he
repeated ; and when upon the third trial he succeeded,
for the birds then returned with their feet stained
with mud, the gods translated him from among men.
With respect to the vessel, which yet remains in
Armenia, it is a custom of the inhabitants to form
bracelets and amulets of its wood. — From Syncellus
38, Eusebius, Prcepar. Evangel, lib. ixt> and Eusebius
Chronic 011 v., 8.

B. Berossus (via Alexander Polyhistor), Of the Ten Kings and the Flood (OCR lines 2985–2999 and 3263–3373; Cory cites Syncellus Chron. 28, Euseb. Chron. 5, 8)

reigned, and he, being the eighth in order, ruled for ten sari. Then Otiartes, a Chaldaean from Laranchae, reigned, and he ruled for eight sari.

Upon the death of Otiartes, his son, Xisuthrus,4 reigned eighteen sari. In his time the great Flood happened. So the sum total of all the kings is ten ; and the period which they collectively reigned amounts to one hundred and twenty sari. — Extracted from the Chronicon of Syncellus 39, and Eusebins Chronicon 5.

1 Sippara, or Sepharvaim.

2 The Persian Gulf.

[...]

soil of the earth, and from thence to form other men and animals, which should be capable of bear- ing the light. Belus also formed the stars, and the sun and the moon, together with the five planets. (In the second book was the history of the ten kings of the Chaldeans, and the periods of each reign, which consisted collectively of one hundred and twenty^sari, or 432,000 years, reaching to the time of the Flood. For Alexander, surnamed Polyhistor, as from the writings of the Chaldeans, enumerating the kings from the ninth, Ardates, to Xisuthrus, who is called by them the tenth, proceeds in this manner :)

After the death of Ardates, his son, Xisuthrus, succeeded, and reigned eighteen sari. In his time happened the great Deluge ; the history of which is given in this manner. The Deity, Kronus, appeared to him in a vision, and gave him notice, that upon

the fifteenth day of the month Daesia1 there would be a flood, by which mankind would be destroyed. He therefore enjoined him to commit to writing a

1 The 5th month of the Macedonian year, answering to May and June.

history of the beginning-, progress, and final conclusion of all things, down to the present term ; and to bury these accounts securely in the city of the Sun1 at Sippara ; and to build a vessel, and to take with him into it his friends and relations ; and to convey on board everything necessary to sustain life, and to take in also all species of animals that either fly, or rove upon the earth ; and trust himself to the deep. Having asked the Deity, whither he was to sail ? he was answered, " To the Gods : " upon which he offered up a prayer for the good of mankind. And he obeyed the divine admonition : and built a vessel five stadia in length, and in breadth two. Into this he put everything which he had got ready ; and last of all conveyed into it his wife, children, and friends. After the Flood had been upon the earth, and was in time abated, Xisuthrus sent out some birds2 from the vessel, which, not finding any food, nor any place to rest their feet, returned to him again. After an interval of some days, he sent them forth a second time, and they now returned with their feet tinged with mud. He made a trial a third time with these birds, but they returned to him no more ; from whence he formed a judgment, that the surface of the earth was now

1 The sun was worshipped by the Assyrians as a God, under the name of S/iamas, the Hebrew Shemesh.

2 Compare with Genesis viii. 7 — 12.

above the waters. Having, therefore, made an opening in the vessel, and finding, upon looking out, that the vessel was driven to the side of a mountain, he immediately quitted it, being attended by his wife, his daughter, and the pilot. Xisuthrus immediately paid his adoration to the earth, and, having constructed an altar, offered sacrifices1 to the gods.

These things being duly performed, both Xisuthrus, and those who came out of the vessel with him, disappeared. They who remained in the vessel, finding that the others did not return, came out, with many lamentations, and called continually on the name of Xisuthrus. They saw him no more, but could distinguish his voice in the air, and could hear him admonish them to pay due regard to the gods. He likewise informed them that it was upon account of his piety that he was translated2 to live with the gods ; that his wife and daughter, with the pilot, had obtained the same honour. To this he added that he would have them make the best of their way to Babylonia, and search for the writings at Sippara, which were to be made known to all mankind : and that the place where they then were was the land of Armenia.3 The remainder having

1 See Genesis viii. 20.

2 Compare with this the translation of Enoch, Genesis v. 23, 24.

3 Compare with Genesis viii. 4. Ararat is the Hebrew name of Armenia. — See 2 Kings xix. 37.

heard these words, offered sacrifices to the gods ; and taking a circuit, journeyed towards Babylonia.

The vessel, being thus stranded in Armenia, some part of it yet remains in the Gordyaean1; mountains in Armenia ; and the people scrape off the bitumen,2 with which it had been outwardly coated, and make use of it by way of an alexipharmic3 and amulet. In this manner they returned to Babylon ; and having found the writings at Sippara, they set about build-